

Motorola V3 Razr

Trendsetting designs have been the hallmark of many Motorola cellphones but somehow they always fell short of critical acclaim. With the V3 Razr, Motorola changes all that.

Motorola resorted to space grade alloys for the body panels making the V3 light and strong. At 3.8 x 2.0 x 0.5 inches, the V3 is pocketable.

Feature-wise, you get Quad-band support, Bluetooth, VGA digital camera with 4x zoom, GPRS, PIM functionality, MPEG 4 video playback and Java support. The V3 has 5MB internal memory but no option for upgrading. Targeted at the fashion-conscious, the V3 should make a strong statement.

Company **Motorola India Pvt Ltd**

Price **Rs 20,095**

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Rating 



SAFA SR-M850F MP3 player

Too Little For Too Much

The SAFA SR-M850F comes at a time when digital portable music players are freely available and an MP3 player is no longer a novelty unless it screams 'iPod'. Enter the SAFA SR-M850F with nothing less than 512MB of solid state memory and a 65K colour screen!

This is a decent MP3 player and supports all major audio formats such as MP3, OGG, and WMA (sorry, no AAC). It also looks glossy and has two tiny 10 mW stereo speakers on either side. The player is packed with features that put other players to shame. Voice recording, reading text files, viewing JPEG files etc.

Feature-wise, this is a solid product, powered by an internal rechargeable battery that lasted 18 hours of continuous MP3 playback using the bundled earphones.

Priced at a whopping Rs 12,100, though, it is too expensive compared to a 4GB iPod Mini that costs just Rs 500 less!

Company **Arihant Informatique Pvt Ltd.**

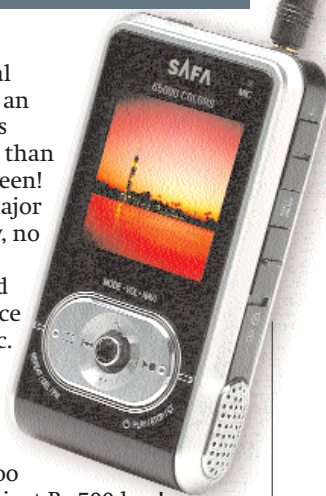
Price **Rs 12,100**

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Web site **www.safa.co.kr**

Rating 



New & Notable

Samsung Miniket VP-M110S

Great Flaunt Value

A digital video camcorder, digital camera, MP3 player, webcam, voice-recorder and a mass storage device—all rolled into one compact device measuring 70 x 30 x 42 mm and weighing just 80 grams! We are talking about the new Miniket VP-M110S from Samsung.

With internal storage of 1 GB and 10X optical and 100X digital zoom, the Miniket also supports additional memory in the form of MemoryStick Pro. The two-inch foldable LCD supports up to 210K colours, and also acts as viewfinder for the video and image capture, apart from displaying the Menu.

The Miniket connects to a PC using the bundled cradle and a USB cable. Windows XP recognises it as a removable storage device and you can transfer music and other data easily to and from your PC.

The Miniket captures videos at 720 x 576 or 352 x 288. There are three quality options—Superfine, Fine and Normal. In the Superfine mode and at 720 x 576 size, the internal memory can accommodate approximately 22 minutes of footage, provided no other files are stored. Videos use a proprietary MPEG 4 standard licensed from DivX Inc.

For stills, you can choose between 800 x 600 and 640 x 480. An 1280 x 960 extrapolated option is also available, and images are captured as JPEG. The flash works only in the Photo mode, and can be set to Auto, ON/OFF.

Customisable options for video and still image capture include Auto/Manual focus, four White Balance modes (Auto,

Hold, Outdoor and Indoor), and five programmed auto exposure modes—'Auto', 'Sports', 'Spotlight', 'Sand/Snow', and 'High Speed Shutter'. You can choose from seven effects, including Sepia or Negative. 'Electronic Image Stabiliser' and 'Backlight Compensation' are also included.

In terms of performance, image quality was not up to the mark, for either video or photos and there was evident Noise. As far as the MP3 player is concerned, it is primitive at best. All you can do is play and listen to music. You can also record voice files in the WAV format in 8 KHz, 128 Kbps stereo mode. It's good only for voice and all other noises are lost in the background.

The device heats up a bit even when used for a short period. Also, battery life is affected by zooming. In our battery tests (which involved playing assorted MP3's over and over), the Miniket could manage about three hours and 15 minutes on the regular 3.8V 900 mAh battery. However, an 1800 mAh extended battery pack is also included in the package.

The Samsung Miniket is a lifestyle product, and not meant for users who want a dedicated digital handycam or an MP3 player. Still, it's great for those who have the cash to spare and want a product with flaunt value.

Company **Samsung India Electronics Limited**

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Rating 

